



PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Coffee Quality Expert and Coffee, Tea and Spices Marketing Information Analyst with over 30 years of progressive experience in coffee extension, quality inspection, cupping, grading, roasting, export certification, regulatory policy and international training. A distinguished specialist across all major Ethiopian Arabica origins including Harar, Yirgacheffe, Sidama, Limu, Jimma, Guji and Bebeka with a proven record of elevating national quality standards, promoting Ethiopian coffee on the world stage, and developing the next generation of coffee professionals. **Certified Q-Grader (CQI, USA)** and **Master Trainer** recognised across East Africa and the United States.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Coffee Copper IV

Jan 2021 – Sep 2023

Ethiopian Coffee and Tea Authority (ECTA) · Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Concurrently: Coffee, Tea and Spices Marketing Information Analyst — Team Leader

Concurrently: Acting Director — Coffee, Tea and Spices Marketing Directorate

- Evaluated and graded coffee quality across all major Ethiopian Arabica origins against national and international export standards, conducting daily cupping sessions assessing fragrance, aroma, flavour, aftertaste, acidity, body, balance, uniformity and overall cup score.
- Directed the collection, analysis and dissemination of domestic and global market data to drive export growth, manage price fluctuations and ensure full sector traceability.
- Developed market forecasts and actionable insights to enhance the global competitiveness of Ethiopian coffee, tea and spice products.
- Provided data-driven policy recommendations on regulatory adjustments to strengthen the sector's competitive advantage in international markets.
- Led regulatory compliance and quality control: enforced national and international standards across moisture levels, foreign matter, grading parameters and organoleptic evaluation.
- Developed and implemented food safety regulations ensuring compliance with HACCP, FDA and CEF frameworks; managed licensing and registration of traders.
- Monitored international price trends and market demand; facilitated technological adoption to optimise the supply chain and meet national export targets.
- Provided timely market information on production, pricing and demand to farmers, cooperatives and exporters, supporting informed export decisions.
- Led export promotion initiatives, identifying new international markets and resolving logistical and marketing bottlenecks.
- Delivered expert training on grading, roasting techniques and sensory evaluation for government and private sector staff.

Coordinator — Coffee Quality Inspection Center

Jan 2010 – Dec 2020

Dire Dawa Coffee Quality Inspection Office · Dire Dawa, Ethiopia

- Directed all technical and administrative operations of the regional inspection center for 10 years.
- Supervised end-to-end sampling, grading and cupping of Harar, Yirgacheffe, Limu, Sidama and Jimma coffee lots destined for export.
- Conducted daily cupping sessions evaluating fragrance, aroma, body, acidity, flavour, aftertaste and overall cup impression for grading and export certification.
- Oversaw quality control for major private exporters, cooperatives and unions across all Ethiopian coffee growing regions.
- Coordinated international training programs with Boot Coffee Consulting and SCAA under USAID funding.
- Organised stakeholder workshops with international buyers to promote traceability and quality standards.
- Oversaw planning, construction and modernisation of coffee laboratory facilities in Dire Dawa.
- Invited participant at 1st through 3rd International Ethiopian Coffee Conferences, Addis Ababa Hilton.

CAREER SNAPSHOT

30+	Q-Grader
Years in Coffee	CQI, USA
6+	20+
Countries	Exporters

ETHIOPIAN ORIGINS

- Harar (Eastern Ethiopia)
- Yirgacheffe (SNNPR)
- Sidama / Sidamo
- Limu (Oromia)
- Jimma (Oromia)
- Guji (Oromia)
- Bebeka (SNNPR)
- Kaffa (SNNPR)

CORE EXPERTISE

- Coffee Cupping and Sensory Analysis
- Quality Grading and Inspection
- Coffee Roasting and Liquoring
- Export Standards and Certification
- Marketing Information Analysis
- Regulatory Policy and Compliance
- Food Safety (HACCP, FDA, CEF)
- Training and Capacity Building
- Traceability Systems
- Team Leadership and Management

EDUCATION

M.S. Agricultural Economics (In Progress)

Haramaya University

B.S. Economics

Haramaya University

Diploma, Management

Alemaya University

Diploma, General Agriculture

Jimma Agricultural College

CERTIFICATIONS

- Q-Grader — Coffee Quality Institute (CQI), USA
- Master Trainer — EAFCA, Kenya
- Università del Caffè — illy Coffee, Italy
- Advanced Industrial Roasting — UNIDO and ECTA



Coffee Quality Inspector, Cupper and Grader

Jan 1995 – Nov 2008

Dire Dawa Coffee Quality Inspection Office · Dire Dawa, Ethiopia

- Conducted raw evaluation and cupping for grading Harar, Yirgacheffe, Limu and Jimma coffee lots for export certification over 13 years.
- Assessed cup quality: fragrance, aroma, body, acidity, flavour, aftertaste, sweetness and overall impression.
- Led inventory audits across warehouses of 19 to 20 Harar coffee exporters; enforced sanitation and quality warehouse standards.
- Planned annual inspection volumes and acted as acting coordinator in the center head's absence.
- Facilitated international buyer and stakeholder workshops under the USAID Agri-business and Trade Expansion Program.
- Performed raw quality grading for arrival and export coffee lots; delivered training workshops for stakeholders across East and West Hararghe.

Coffee Extension Agent and Inventory Supervisor

Sep 1990 – Dec 1994

Eastern Hararghe Region — Ethiopian Government · Hararghe, Ethiopia

- Trained farmers in nursery preparation, proper red cherry harvesting and post-harvest handling techniques.
- Supervised quarterly and annual inventory for 20+ exporters' warehouses in the region.
- Supported improved coffee quality pipelines from farm gate to international export market readiness.

INTERNATIONAL EXPERIENCE AND GLOBAL ENGAGEMENT

SCAA Expo — Seattle, USA

April 2014

Represented Ethiopia at North America's premier specialty coffee event. Promoted Ethiopian Arabica to an international audience of roasters and importers, discussing trade opportunities, origin traceability and quality positioning of Ethiopia's diverse coffee regions.

Morocco and France — International Coffee Exhibitions

Multiple Years

Participated in international coffee exhibitions in Morocco and France, actively promoting Ethiopian coffee on the world stage. Distributed coffee bean samples, engaged in hands-on cupping demonstrations with attendees, answered technical and trade questions about Ethiopian origins, and facilitated conversations on export partnerships. Gained valuable comparative experience with coffees from Brazil, Vietnam and across East Africa.

Università del Caffè — Trieste, Italy (illy Coffee)

Italy

Completed the intensive professional certification program at illy's world-renowned training institution, gaining deep expertise in espresso science, industrial and artisan roasting principles, coffee history and evolution, grinder calibration, extraction theory, barista techniques, cappuccino preparation, sensory tasting analysis and quality standards. Received hands-on training at the illycaffè production plant in Trieste.

1st through 3rd Ethiopian Coffee Conferences

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Held at Hilton Hotel Addis Ababa. Contributed to expert panels on quality improvement, traceability systems and the sustainable competitiveness of Ethiopian fine coffee supply chains.

4th International Coffee Exhibition and Conference

Addis Ababa, 2016

Raised critical discourse on global pricing inefficiencies relative to growing world demand for fine Ethiopian Arabica.

Master Trainers Program — EAFCA

Nairobi, Kenya

Certified as Master Trainer by East African Fine Coffees Association, enabling cross-regional training of trainers across East Africa.

HONOURS AND AWARDS

LOGO Award — Special Contribution Recognition

Boot Coffee Consulting and Training (USA) · Presented in Ethiopia

Awarded for outstanding contribution to Harar coffee stakeholder training coordination conducted at SAMRAT Hotel, Ethiopia. Recognised by Boot Coffee USA for excellence in knowledge transfer and industry capacity building across the Ethiopian coffee sector.

- Coffee Quality Inspection: Raw, Roasting and Liquoring — 3-yr CLU, ECTA
- Advanced Cupping and Flavor Profile — Boot Coffee
- Advanced Coffee Liquoring — Boot Coffee
- Coffee Selection and Preparation — Boot Coffee
- Advanced Coffee Roasting — UNIGO / ECTA
- Project Cycle Management — Hawassa
- Leadership for Nutrition Security — Hawassa
- Agribusiness Competitiveness — Adama
- Business Process Re-engineering — Debrezeit

HONOURS AND AWARDS

★ LOGO Award — Boot Coffee USA

Special Contribution Recognition — Harar Coffee Stakeholder Training, SAMRAT Hotel, Ethiopia.

LANGUAGES

English	Professional
Amharic	Fluent
Oromiffa	Fluent
Tigrigna	Fluent